“Money can fix any problem.”

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Where it often comes from

When money has solved real problems, such as a repair, a medical bill, or a hard season, it is easy to conclude that it can solve everything. Families who handle conflict by paying for it, or who show love with gifts, can pass this lesson on. The belief holds until a problem comes along that money cannot touch, such as grief, a broken trust, loneliness, or a wandering heart.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture teaches that money is useful but limited. “He who loves money is never satisfied by money.” “Riches are worthless in the day of wrath, but righteousness brings deliverance from death.” Jesus asked, “What does it profit a man to gain the whole world, yet forfeit his soul?” Paul learned to be content in every situation, because his strength came from Christ. God gives wealth for good use, but the deepest problems need what money cannot buy: forgiveness, love, presence, and truth.

> *“He who loves money is never satisfied by money, and he who loves wealth is never satisfied by income. This too is futile”* (Ecclesiastes 5:10).

Also see

> “Riches are worthless in the day of wrath, but righteousness brings deliverance from death” (Proverbs 11:4).

> “Some trust in chariots and others in horses, but we trust in the name of the LORD our God” (Psalm 20:7).

> “I know how to live humbly, and I know how to abound. I am accustomed to any and every situation—to being filled and being hungry, to having plenty and having need. I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength” (Philippians 4:12–13).

> “What does it profit a man to gain the whole world, yet forfeit his soul?” (Mark 8:36).

Common self-statements

- If I just had enough money, this would be solved.
- I can pay my way out of anything.
- Problems are only a matter of resources.
- Giving gifts shows people I care.
- Money is the answer to every worry.
- If it cannot be bought, it does not matter.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralizing: Turning “money solved this” into “money solves everything.”
- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing every problem as either solvable with money or hopeless.
- Mental filter: Noticing what money has fixed and overlooking what it could not.
- Magnification: Treating money as far more powerful than it is.

Challenging questions

- What problems have I faced that money could not fix?

- What do I feel when money cannot solve a problem?
- Is there a relationship or need I have tried to solve with money instead of time and presence?
- What does the Bible say about the limits of wealth?
- What would it look like to bring this problem to God and to people, not only to my accounts?
- What is one thing I need that money cannot buy?

Truth summary

> Money is a good tool, but it cannot forgive me, heal my grief, or love me. Some of life's deepest needs are met only by God and by people. I can use my resources wisely and also turn to what money can never provide.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Money
- Riches, Beware of
- Trust
- Worldly
- Thankful

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Money/Riches
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

All Things New — Steven Curtis Chapman
God's renewing work offers hope beyond failure, decay, and loss.

What You Want — Tenth Avenue North
Following God involves trust and surrender without needing control of every outcome.

Turn Your Eyes Upon Jesus — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn directs attention to Christ when fear or earthly concerns dominate.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Money can fix any problem"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Money can fix any problem." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What problem have I tried to solve with money that needs something else?
- ☐ What can money never buy for me?
- ☐ What would presence look like instead of payment?
- ☐ Where do I need to trust God more than my resources?
- ☐ What is enough today?
- ☐ Who needs my time more than my gift?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Money is a tool, not a savior.
- ☐ Some problems need presence, not payment.
- ☐ God provides what money cannot buy.
- ☐ I can use money wisely and trust God.
- ☐ I can be content in many situations.
- ☐ Time and love are worth more than gifts.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Ecclesiastes 5:10**
  "He who loves money is never satisfied by money, and he who loves wealth is never satisfied by income. This too is futile."
- ☐ **Philippians 4:12–13**
  "I know how to live humbly, and I know how to abound. I am accustomed to any and every situation—to being filled and being hungry, to having plenty and having need. I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength."
- ☐ **Mark 8:36**
  "What does it profit a man to gain the whole world, yet forfeit his soul?"

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] What money could and could not do: Each week, write one problem that money helped and one that it could not touch, and what helped that one.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Ecclesiastes 5:10 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Money is useful, but my deepest needs are met by God and by people.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Riches, Beware of" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] Sort your problems. Make two lists: problems money can help and problems it cannot. Notice what is on the second list.
- [ ] Give time, not only money. Spend an hour with someone this week with no gift attached.
- [ ] Bring one money-proof problem to God. Pray specifically about a problem that cannot be bought off.
- [ ] Practice contentment. Name three things that are enough today.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie “Money can fix any problem”: _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	What money could not buy
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Money can fix any problem.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, thank You for what You provide. Keep me from trusting in money to save me. Help me turn to You and to people for what money cannot buy, and teach me to be content in You. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.